

TELECOM MARKET INTELLIGENCE — MONTHLY PULSE

North Macedonia Telecommunications Market

June 2026 — Competitive Intensity Brief

Run date: 2026-06-09

Operators covered: Makedonski Telekom, A1 Macedonia, One Macedonia (new entrant)

Research window: Last 90 days (baseline refresh: 18 months)

Year So Far

North Macedonia's mobile market has been defined in the first half of 2026 by a single structural event: the entry of One Macedonia (backed by Hungarian group 4iG) as the country's third mobile network operator, following its spectrum award in January 2026. Makedonski Telekom has maintained strong incumbent momentum — posting 6% revenue growth and subscriber gains across all segments in Q1 2026 — while A1 Macedonia faces dual pressure from a well-resourced new entrant building a greenfield 5G network and a dominant rival still taking share. The new Electronic Communications Act, which activates 1-day MNP at no charge from 1 June 2026, lowers the switching barrier precisely as One Macedonia prepares to launch commercially.

Last 90 Days

DIRECTIONAL VERDICT

Intensifying — The entry of One Macedonia as a licensed 5G MNO is the most significant structural disruption in the Macedonian market in over a decade; competitive pressure will rise materially as One begins commercial service, forcing both incumbents to respond on pricing and network investment.

- **New entrant — One Macedonia licence granted** — AEK officially awarded the third mobile operator licence to One Macedonia Telecommunications (4iG Group) on 12 January 2026, paying €8.02M in spectrum fees; initially operating in Skopje on national roaming while building its own infrastructure. ([MIA, 2026-01](#))
- **Infrastructure — One Macedonia/Ericsson 5G SA deal** — Full general contract signed at MWC Barcelona (March 2026) for one of the Western Balkans' first 5G Standalone networks; obligations: one city by end-March 2027, major corridors by 2028, all cities by 2030. ([Albanian Daily News, 2026-03](#))
- **Regulatory — New Electronic Communications Act in force** — Fully applicable from 1 June 2026; activates 1-day number portability at no charge, caps contract durations, simplifies switching — directly lowering the barrier to migrate to One Macedonia at launch. ([Schoenherr, 2025](#))

- **Earnings — Makedonski Telekom Q1 2026** — Revenue +6% YoY; mobile +1.9% to 1.28M subs; fixed broadband +3.5% to 226k; TV +6.1% to 171k. Incumbents appear to be locking in subscribers before One Macedonia activates. ([Telecompaper, 2026](#))
- **M&A — Mtel acquires Lycamobile** — Bosnian operator Mtel finalized the acquisition of Lycamobile's North Macedonia operations; future commercial strategy undisclosed — either a prepaid disruptor or a passive MVNO holdco. ([Telecompaper, 2025](#))
- **Pricing — +33% ITU basket rise** — ITU mobile basket price rose +33% YoY to ~USD 14.50 in 2025, the sharpest increase in the region — a pricing luxury that disappears once One Macedonia activates with introductory offers. ([WorldData.info, 2025](#))

Outlook to Year-End

- **One Macedonia commercial launch** — Pre-commercial in Skopje now; a formal H2 2026 launch with introductory pricing under the new 1-day MNP rules would immediately test incumbent retention and could trigger the first real price war in Macedonia's telecom market in years.
- **Incumbent pricing response** — Both A1 and Makedonski Telekom are currently repricing upward (+33% ITU basket 2025); One Macedonia's entry will force at least one of them into a mid-cycle retention tariff by Q3–Q4 2026. A1 is the more exposed given Makedonski Telekom's Q1 subscriber momentum.
- **Mtel/Lycamobile commercial direction** — Mtel's strategy for the acquired Lycamobile base will become clearer H2 2026; a prepaid disruptor scenario compounds pressure on incumbents; a passive hold is neutral. No signals yet.

Sources

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One Macedonia and Ericsson sign general contract on 5G network — Albanian Daily News, 2026-03

North Macedonia passes new Electronic Communications Act — Schoenherr, 2025

Makedonski Telekom reports 6% revenue growth in Q1 2026 — Telecompaper, 2026

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North Macedonia launches 5G spectrum tender for new market entrants — C-PRAV Group, 2025-04

North Macedonia 5G spectrum allocation — Spectrum Tracker, 2026

North Macedonia telecommunication statistics — WorldData.info, 2025

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